

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 7 5 4 3

♥ Q T 3

♦ A 4

♣ J T 3

♠ A T 2

♥ A J 7

♦ J 8 6 2

♣ K 6 5



♠ J 6

♥ 9 8 5 2

♦ 9 7 5

♣ A Q 9 8

♠ K Q 9

♥ K 6 4

♦ K Q T 3

♣ 7 4 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

♥Q, it didn't do anything that declarer wouldn't have done on his own.

Declarer must play ♦s to get some winners, and when West takes the ♦A he will surely switch to the ♣J. Down goes declarer.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♥9, the top of nothing.

Your ♣s are so good that all your instincts tell you to lead the ♣8, and perhaps set up 3 winners.

If you had one more small ♣s your instincts would be right, but with only a 4-card suit you should think a little longer. Three tricks won't set this contract, so you must depend on partner winning something. And if partner is going to win something perhaps he will lead a ♣ and you might make FOUR tricks in the suit.

So lead the ♥9. You lead a high card so partner won't be tempted to return the suit when he gets the lead. Note that although this lead finesses partner's

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K T 8
♥ 7
♦ A 7 5 3 2
♣ 8 5 3 2

♠ 5
♥ K Q 9 6 3
♦ K 6
♣ K Q T 9 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 9 7 6 2
♥ A 8 5 4
♦ 4
♣ 7 4

♠ A 4 3
♥ J T 2
♦ Q J T 9 8
♣ A J

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	2 ♠	3 ♦
3 ♠	4 ♣	Pass	4 ♥
Pass	Pass	4 ♠	Dbl
All Pass			

4 ♠ X by East

will still be able to ruff one ♥ in dummy, but will be left with two losing ♥s and will be down 2. Without the two trump plays he could have ruffed all three of his ♥ losers and actually made the contract.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4 ♠ doubled

Lead the ♠ A.

East's 2 ♠ bid is a Weak-jump Overcall, based on a 6-card ♠ suit and a weak hand.

Either the ♦ Q or ♥ J would normally be good leads.

But on this deal West/East have clearly sacrificed against your almost certain ♥ game. Since they don't have enough high-card strength to make this contract declarer is hoping to get some ruffs.

The way to cut down the number of ruffs he can make is to lead a trump at every opportunity.

So take the ♠ A and then play another ♠. Declarer will still be able to ruff one ♥ in dummy, but will be left with two losing ♥s and will be down 2. Without the two trump plays he could have ruffed all three of his ♥ losers and actually made the contract.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 7 3

♥ Q T 7 3

♦ 7 5

♣ 6 3 2

♠ T 6 4

♥ 6 4 2

♦ K 9 4 2

♣ A K J



♠ Q 9 2

♥ K 8 5

♦ A 8 6

♣ T 9 7 5

♠ A J 5

♥ A J 9

♦ Q J T 3

♣ Q 8 4

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

1NT

All Pass

3NT by South

cannot establish the ♠ winner.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♥3, fourth highest in an attacking suit.

Sometimes it comes down to just this kind of choice.

Do you lead fourth down from ♠ K 8 7 3 or from ♥ Q 10 7 3.

The presence of the ♥10 bolsters the ♥ suit enough to give it the edge.

The suits could be arranged something like shown at left. With a ♠ lead the presence of the ♠T in dummy allows declarer to make a second ♠ trick, which happens to be declarer's ninth trick.

But when you lead the ♥3 it does not promote a ♥ winner for declarer, and left to his own devices, he

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q J 9 5 4

♥ A J T

♦ 6

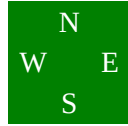
♣ A 5 2

♠ 6 3

♥ K 6 3

♦ A 7 4

♣ T 9 8 7 4



♠ A T

♥ 9 4

♦ K Q J 9 8 3

♣ K Q J

♠ 8 7 2

♥ Q 8 7 5 2

♦ T 5 2

♣ 6 3

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

Pass

3 ♦

Pass

3 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

Pass

4NT

Pass

5 ♦

Pass

6 ♠

All Pass

6 ♠ by West

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6 ♠

Lead the ♥3.

The ♣T would probably be a very safe lead. But you don't want "safe", you want "attack".

Dummy has advertised a long, strong ♦ suit which declarer will no doubt establish for discards.

It is important for your side to create a winner before your ♦A is forced out. The most likely looking winner is your ♥K. So lead the small ♥ and hope partner has the Queen.

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q J T 8

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A 5

♣ 9 6 3

♠ 5 3

♥ K Q J

♦ Q J T 9 7

♣ A T 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 4

♥ T 9 8 4

♦ 8 6 3 2

♣ K 8 7 2

♠ A 9 7 6 2

♥ A 6 3

♦ K 4

♣ Q J 5

West

North

East

South

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

Dbl

All Pass

3NT by North

With any other lead declarer will make the contract.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♠ 4.

If partner had not doubled the contract you would probably have started with the ♥ 10, or possibly the ♣ 2.

But partner DID double, and most good players play that doubling 3NT is lead-directing as follows: If you have bid a suit, lead it. If doubler has bid a suit, lead it. If neither of you has bid, lead dummy's first bid suit.

So lead a ♠, certainly not a lead you would have made without the double. Partner immediately establishes 4 ♠ winners and he has the ♦ A for an entry.

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

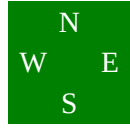
♠ A 8 6 4
 ♥ A J 6 5
 ♦ Q 7
 ♣ J 6 3

♠ 5 2

♥ Q 7 3

♦ 8 4 2

♣ A K Q 7 4



♠ K Q 7

♥ K T 9 8

♦ A K 5

♣ T 9 2

♠ J T 9 3

♥ 4 2

♦ J T 9 6 3

♣ 8 5

West

North

East

South

2♣

Dbl

2♥

1NT

Pass

4♥

Pass

All Pass

4♥ by East

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4♥

Lead the ♣8.

If partner had not doubled West's Stayman 2♣ bid you would probably have started with one of your Jacks.

But partner **DID** double, and the double of a conventional bid clearly means that the doubler would like you to lead that suit.

So lead a ♣, and partner will take three ♣ tricks. With any other lead declarer would quickly discard a ♣ from dummy on a high ♦, easily making the contract.

Declarer may still make the contract if he guesses the ♥Q correctly, but maybe not.